

BAAHUBALI

The Beginning (2015) • The Conclusion (2017)

An Indian epic action film franchise created by director S. S. Rajamouli, told across two parts. Set in the mythical kingdom of Mahishmati, it weaves royal ambition, betrayal, love and revenge into one of the most successful sagas in the history of Indian cinema. Made simultaneously in Telugu and Tamil and dubbed into Hindi, Malayalam and other languages, the franchise became a nationwide phenomenon - most famously for the cliffhanger question that gripped the country for two years: **"Why did Kattappa kill Baahubali?"**

Franchise at a Glance

Director	S. S. Rajamouli
Story / Writer	K. V. Vijayendra Prasad (screenplay & dialogues with Rajamouli)
Producers	Shobu Yarlagadda & Prasad Devineni (Arka Media Works)
Music	M. M. Keeravani
Cinematography	K. K. Senthil Kumar
Production Design	Sabu Cyril
Languages	Telugu & Tamil (original); dubbed in Hindi, Malayalam and more
Genre	Epic historical action / fantasy drama
Parts	Baahubali: The Beginning (2015); Baahubali 2: The Conclusion (2017)
Legacy	Baahubali 2 was the first Indian film to gross over Rs 1,000 crore worldwide

The Story

Part 1 - Baahubali: The Beginning (2015)

A woman flees a collapsing kingdom clutching an infant, escaping soldiers led by the cruel commander. As she is swept away by a river, she raises the baby above the water with her last strength before drowning. The child is rescued by a tribal community living at the foot of a colossal waterfall and is raised as **Shivudu**.

Growing up, Shivudu is drawn by an irresistible pull to climb the towering waterfall. After many attempts he finally scales it and discovers a world beyond - and a young warrior named **Avanthika**, part of a rebel group fighting the tyrant king **Bhallaladeva**. Their mission is to free **Devasena**, a queen who has been held in chains for twenty-five years. Shivudu takes up the cause, infiltrates the capital of Mahishmati, and frees Devasena.

In the ensuing battle Shivudu's true identity is revealed: he is **Mahendra Baahubali**, son of the beloved late prince **Amarendra Baahubali**. The kingdom's old and loyal slave-warrior **Kattappa** kneels before him. When Shivudu asks how his heroic father died, Kattappa delivers the film's shattering final line - that it was he, Kattappa, who killed Baahubali.

Part 2 - Baahubali 2: The Conclusion (2017)

The second film unfolds largely as a flashback that answers the question the nation was asking. Years earlier, the wise queen mother **Sivagami** rules Mahishmati as regent and raises two cousins as heirs: the noble, beloved **Amarendra Baahubali** and the ambitious, resentful **Bhallaladeva**. After both prove themselves in a great battle against the invading Kalakeya horde, Sivagami names Amarendra as the future king, while Bhallaladeva is made commander.

Sent to tour the kingdom, Amarendra meets and falls in love with **Devasena**, the spirited princess of Kuntala. Bhallaladeva, coveting both the throne and Devasena, manipulates his scheming father **Bijjaladeva** and deceives Sivagami into promising Devasena to him. The misunderstanding spirals: Amarendra chooses Devasena over blind obedience, is stripped of his position, and is eventually cast out - yet remains adored by the common people.

Perceiving Amarendra as a threat to the crown, Bhallaladeva engineers a conspiracy and convinces Sivagami that Amarendra means to seize power. Kattappa, bound by an unbreakable oath of loyalty to the throne of Mahishmati, is ordered to act. Trapped between his love for Amarendra and his sacred duty, Kattappa is forced to stab Baahubali in the back. Realising too late that she has been deceived, a grief-stricken Sivagami declares Amarendra's infant son the true king before she is betrayed - setting the stage for the child who will grow up to be Shivudu / Mahendra Baahubali.

In the present, Mahendra Baahubali rallies the people and the loyal Kattappa, storms Mahishmati, and confronts Bhallaladeva in a final battle. He avenges his father, frees his mother Devasena, and reclaims the throne - restoring justice to the kingdom.

Principal Characters

Amarendra Baahubali - The noble, courageous and beloved prince of Mahishmati; a natural leader chosen by Sivagami to be king. His integrity ultimately makes him a target.

Mahendra Baahubali (Shivudu) - Amarendra's son, raised in secret by tribal folk. He rediscovers his heritage, avenges his father and reclaims the kingdom. (Same actor plays father and son.)

Bhallaladeva - Amarendra's envious cousin. Cunning and ruthless, he schemes his way to the throne and rules as a tyrant - the saga's central antagonist.

Kattappa - The fiercely loyal slave-warrior sworn to serve the throne of Mahishmati across generations. His forced killing of Baahubali is the emotional heart of the story.

Devasena - The proud, principled princess of Kuntala and Amarendra's wife; Mahendra's mother. Imprisoned for 25 years, she never surrenders her dignity.

Rajamata Sivagami - The powerful queen mother and regent whose sense of duty and one fatal misjudgement shape the kingdom's tragedy.

Bijjaladeva - Bhallaladeva's embittered, physically disabled father, denied the crown; the poisonous voice behind his son's ambition.

Avanthika - A skilled warrior in the rebel resistance and Shivudu's love interest in the first film.

Kumara Varma - Devasena's cousin, a comic yet loyal figure whose pride is exploited in the palace intrigue.

Cast

Prabhas	Amarendra Baahubali / Mahendra Baahubali (dual role)
Rana Daggubati	Bhallaladeva
Anushka Shetty	Devasena
Tamannaah	Avanthika
Ramya Krishnan	Rajamata Sivagami
Sathyaraj	Kattappa
Nassar	Bijjaladeva
Subbaraju	Kumara Varma
Prabhakar / Adivi Sesh & others	Supporting roles (commanders, kin, warriors)

Direction & Key Crew

Director	S. S. Rajamouli - among India's most acclaimed filmmakers
Writer	K. V. Vijayendra Prasad (Rajamouli's father) - original story
Cinematographer	K. K. Senthil Kumar
Production Designer	Sabu Cyril - built the vast Mahishmati sets
Music Director	M. M. Keeravani
Studio	Arka Media Works
VFX	Multiple studios; landmark visual-effects work for Indian cinema

The two films were shot together over several years on enormous purpose-built sets, combining practical construction with extensive visual effects to bring the kingdom of Mahishmati - its palaces, waterfalls and battlefields - to life on an unprecedented scale for Indian cinema.

Music Album

The soundtrack and background score were composed by **M. M. Keeravani**. The music - sweeping, choral and rooted in Indian classical and folk traditions - became integral to the epic's grandeur. Telugu lyrics were largely penned by the composer and collaborators, with Hindi versions written by Manoj Muntashir.

Notable Songs

Dhivara - The Beginning - a soaring anthem accompanying Shivudu's climb up the waterfall.

Manohari - The Beginning - a lively, festive dance number.

Pacha Bottesina - The Beginning - a romantic melody.

Mamatala Talli / Kanna Nidurinchara - A tender lullaby theme tied to the saga's mother-and-child motif.

Saahore Baahubali - The Conclusion - a triumphant celebration of the hero.

Hamsa Naava - The Conclusion - a serene, devotional-styled duet.

Dandaalayyaa - The Conclusion - a devotional, emotionally charged piece.

Veeron Ke Veer Aa - The Conclusion (Hindi) - a martial, rousing track.

Reception, Records & Legacy

Baahubali: The Beginning (2015) was a massive critical and commercial success and won the National Film Award for Best Feature Film, among other honours. Baahubali 2: The Conclusion (2017) shattered box-office records to become the first Indian film to gross over **Rs 1,000 crore** worldwide, with a global total widely reported above Rs 1,700 crore. Together the films earned National Film Awards (including for special effects) and numerous South Indian and Filmfare awards.

Beyond the numbers, Baahubali reshaped expectations for Indian cinema - proving that a regional-language epic could command a pan-India and global audience, and turning its cast, director and the line "Why did Kattappa kill Baahubali?" into enduring pop-culture landmarks.

Themes & Symbols

Duty vs. love - Almost every tragedy in the saga flows from characters torn between personal loyalty and sworn duty - above all Kattappa, and Sivagami.

Legitimate power - The story asks who deserves to rule: the one born to it, the one who seizes it, or the one the people love.

The mother figure - Sivagami and Devasena anchor the epic; motherhood, sacrifice and protection recur from the opening scene onward.

Fate and lineage - Shivudu's pull toward the waterfall symbolises destiny and the call of his true heritage.

Trivia

- The cliffhanger "Why did Kattappa kill Baahubali?" became a national obsession and a viral meme for the two years between the films.
- Both films were shot simultaneously in Telugu and Tamil, with the same scenes performed for each version.
- The colossal Mahishmati sets and the waterfall were created through a mix of large practical construction and extensive visual effects.
- Baahubali 2 opened to record-breaking collections and became the first Indian film to cross Rs 1,000 crore worldwide.
- The franchise expanded into novels, an animated series and other media exploring the world's backstory.

Key Terms (Glossary)

Mahishmati	The mighty fictional kingdom at the centre of the saga.
Kuntala	Devasena's home kingdom.
Kalakeya	The invading barbarian horde defeated in the great battle.
Rajamata	"Queen mother" - Sivagami's title as regent ruler.
Baahubali	"One with strong arms" - a title of the heroic prince(s).

This document is a study/reference sheet prepared for a RAG hackathon. Figures such as box-office totals are widely reported approximations and may vary by source.